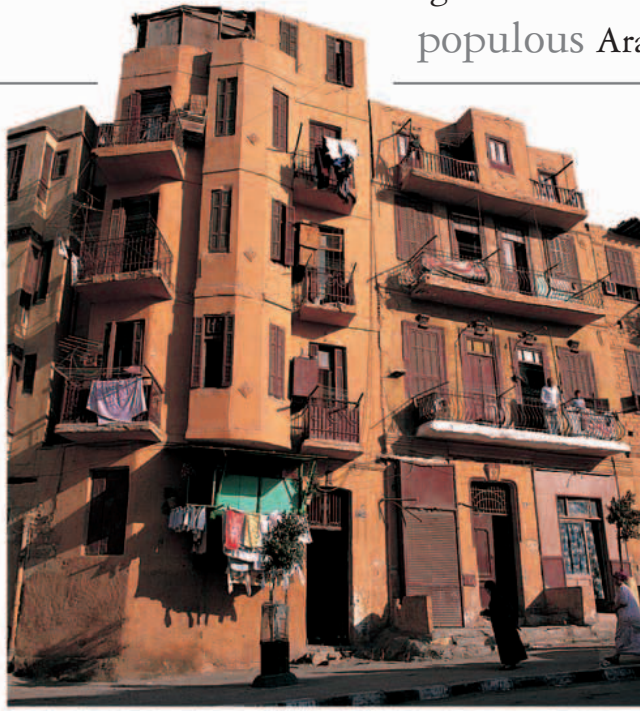




Romans, as well as Muslim, Turkish, and European colonial powers in more recent times. Today, 69 million people live in Egypt, making it the most populous Arab



A MIXED POPULATION

Most of Egypt's population is Egyptian, but Alexandria and Cairo particularly are also home to Bedouins, Berbers, Lebanese, Nubians, Syrians, and Sudanese from elsewhere in Africa and the Middle East, and also to many Europeans.

ABU SIMBEL

This temple in the south of Egypt was built by Pharaoh Rameses II around 1200 BC. In 1968 it was moved so its original site could be flooded to make room for the Aswan Dam, which provides water and electricity for all Egypt.



country by a long stretch. Most are Muslims and Arabic is the national language. The country has been run as a republic since 1952. Tourism and tolls from the Suez Canal are Egypt's biggest industries.

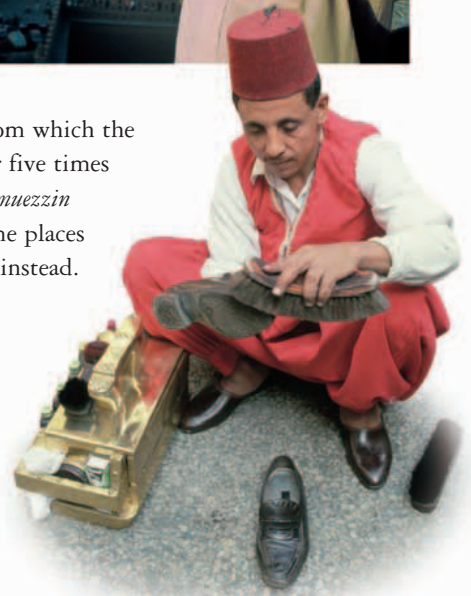


THE CALL TO PRAYER

Next to every mosque is a tower from which the Muslim faithful are called to prayer five times a day. Traditionally a man called a *muezzin* sings out the *salat* (call), but in some places loudspeakers broadcast a recording instead.

SPIT AND POLISH

This shoe-shiner makes his living by cleaning people's shoes in the street. Shoe-shiners are a common sight in even the smallest towns and villages in Egypt.



GIFTS OF THE NILE

This farmer is using donkey power to raise water for irrigating his crops. For centuries though, Egyptian farmers relied on the annual flooding of the Nile River to water their fields. Since the Aswan Dam was built the floods no longer occur. Instead, rain water is captured and stored in a reservoir until it is needed.

